

Week 1 / Thursday

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Literacies

Specialized and practical knowledge, usually related to communication, within a particular context.

- ▶ Academic literacies
- ▶ Professional literacies
- ▶ Digital literacies

Selber's Multiliteracies

- ▶ **Functional literacy:** Our ability to effectively *use* tools and technologies for communication tasks.
- ▶ **Critical literacy:** Our Our ability to analyze and critique the use and effects of tools and technologies at the individual, organizational, and public levels.
- ▶ **Rhetorical literacy:** Our ability to consider and employ tools and technologies for persuasive goals.

Critical Terms

- ▶ Agency and determinism.
- ▶ Affordances and limitations.

Agency and Determinism

- ▶ **Agency:** The degree of freedom and control we have in a particular situation.
- ▶ **Determinism:** The degree to which a particular situation determines our possibilities.

Affordances and Limitations

- ▶ **Affordances:** The uses, activities, and practices that are afforded, suggested, and/or incentivized by a tool or technology. More simply: What a tool allows or suggests that you do with it.
- ▶ **Limitations:** Uses, activities, and practices that are limited or impossible with a particular tool.

A Non-Profit Fundraising Campaign: Instagram Post

What are the affordances and limitations of the medium?

A Non-Profit Fundraising Campaign: A Snail Mail Campaign

What are the affordances and limitations of the medium?

Discussion Question

What affordances and limitations did your assigned tool offer in the earlier activity?